

How Money Manager works

Every feature in the app, why it exists, and what each field on its form actually does with the value you put in it. Written for you to read once, or to hand to anyone who asks "wait, what does that field do?"

Spring Boot · PostgreSQL · Flyway · JWT auth — React · Vite · Tailwind · Recharts

FOUNDATIONS



Accounts

Every rupee in the app lives in an account — a bank account, a cash wallet, a card. Every transaction, EMI, udhar entry, and split bill moves an account's balance, so the balance is always a live number, not something you recompute.

name	What you call it — "HDFC Savings", "Wallet cash". Shown everywhere else this account is referenced.
type	Bank / Cash / Card — grouping only, doesn't change behavior, just how it's labeled.
balance	Set once as your opening balance. After that it's read-only here — it only moves because a transaction, EMI, udhar, or split bill touched it.



Transactions

The ledger. Every income or expense you log by hand goes here, and it's also where EMLs, recurring items, and split-bill settlements land automatically once confirmed.

account	Which account's balance this changes.
category	Optional. Drives the dashboard's spend-by-category chart and the essential/non-essential split — skip it and the transaction just won't show up in either.
type	Income adds to the account balance, Expense subtracts.
amount	Always positive — the type field decides the direction.
description	Free text. Shown as the transaction's label if there's no category, or alongside the category name if there is.
date	Which month it counts toward on the dashboard and in monthly totals.



Categories

Fifteen categories come pre-loaded (Salary, Rent, Groceries, Dining Out, Travel...); you can add your own too. Their only real job is the essential/non-essential flag.

name	Shown on transactions and in the dashboard's category chart.
essential	True/false. Non-essential spend is what shows up under the dashboard's "money wasted" panel — it's a want-vs-need split, not a hard restriction.

Rename a category or mark it essential/non-essential any time — past transactions using it re-classify automatically since they just reference it by id.

 Dashboard

The month at a glance, computed fresh from this month's transactions every time you open it — nothing here is stored separately from the ledger.

income / expense	Sum of this month's Income and Expense transactions.
savings	income - expense for the month.
savings rate	savings ÷ income × 100 — shown as a %.
vs last month	This month's savings compared against last month's, as a % change, so you can tell if you're trending better or worse.
spend by category	Pie chart of this month's expense totals grouped by category.
money wasted	Sum of this month's expenses tagged to a non-essential category — the "did I need to spend that?" number.

OBLIGATIONS



EMI

Loan installments that should log themselves. A nightly job checks every active EMI and, once its due day has passed this month, auto-creates the expense transaction — no manual confirmation needed.

account	Where the EMI amount gets deducted from automatically each month.
loan name	Your label for it — "Car loan", "Home loan".
principal / interest rate / tenure	Kept for your own record only — not used to recompute anything yet, just shown back to you.
EMI amount	The fixed sum that gets logged as an expense every month.
start date	Informational — when the loan began.
due day (1-28)	The nightly job auto-logs the expense on/after this day of each month, once, capped at 28 so it works in every month including February.

Auto-logs silently — unlike recurring transactions below, an EMI doesn't ask "did you pay this?" first. It assumes yes, because EMIs are auto-debited by the bank regardless.



Fixed Deposits

Tracks money locked away, and flags when it's about to come back.

bank name

Which bank holds it.

principal

What you put in.

interest rate

Informational — not compounded automatically anywhere.

start date / maturity date

Maturity date is what drives the "maturing soon" flag — it lights up inside 30 days of maturity.

maturity amount

What you'll get back — you enter this directly, the app doesn't calculate it from rate and tenure.



Insurance

Premium due dates are easy to forget — this flags them before they're late.

type

Health / Life / Vehicle — grouping only.

policy name

Your label for it.

premium amount

What's due each cycle.

due date

Drives the "due soon" flag, which lights up inside 15 days of this date.

frequency

Monthly / Quarterly / Half-yearly / Yearly — a label for how often it recurs; you still update the due date yourself after paying.

Obligations also shows your **EMI-to-income ratio** — $\text{total monthly EMI} \div \text{total monthly income} \times 100$ — flagged unhealthy above 40%, the same rule of thumb lenders use.



Recurring transactions

For anything monthly that *isn't* an EMI — mobile recharge, rent, sending money to parents, subscriptions, salary — where you'd rather confirm it happened than have it silently assumed.

account / category / type / amount / description Same meaning as a regular transaction — this is the template used to create one.

day of month (1-28) On or after this day, your next login shows a popup: "did you pay this?"

Yes logs it and moves the account balance. **View details** shows the account/category/amount before you decide. Closing the popup without answering just asks again next login — nothing is assumed paid.

MONEY WITH PEOPLE



Udhar (lend / borrow)

Money lent or borrowed with a person, not tracked through the group/split-bill system — the other person doesn't need an account here at all.

contact name Free text — no invite, no account needed for them.

type **Lent** (I gave) or **Borrowed** (I took) — decides which direction it shows in your owed-to-you / you-owe totals.

amount / note / due date Due date is a reminder only, nothing auto-fires on it.

account Optional. Link one and the balance moves immediately (lending = money out, borrowing = money in). Leave it blank to track the IOU without touching any balance.

Settle marks it resolved and, if it was linked to an account, reverses that original balance effect — because the money has now actually changed hands outside the app.



Split bills

You paid for something as a group — a dinner, a trip, a movie outing — and want to collect people's shares back, without setting up a shared group for a one-off.

title / bill date / note	What it was for and when.
total amount	What you paid, in full, upfront.
account	Optional. If picked, the whole total is deducted from it immediately — you fronted the money.
participants (name + share)	Who owes you what. Your own share isn't entered — it's just $total - sum\ of\ everyone\ else's\ shares$.

Mark paid on a participant credits their share back to the linked account and flags them settled — so the account balance always reflects what you're actually still out of pocket.



Groups

For ongoing shared spending — roommates, a recurring trip crew — where wishlist items and contribution requests need a fixed set of people.

name	The group's label.
invite code	An 8-character code, generated automatically, that others enter to join. Membership is shared; each member's own accounts and transactions stay completely private.

★ Wishlist

Things you want to buy, with an honest check on whether you actually can right now.

name / price / product **Link** is optional, just makes the item clickable.

group Optional — link it to a group if you might ask others to chip in for it.

Check affordability compares the price against your available account funds and returns one of three verdicts — affordable, comfortable with a buffer, or short — plus a plain-language recommendation. If it's short and linked to a group, you can request the shortfall from specific members (see Contribution requests).

📦 Contribution requests

The payment loop that closes the gap a wishlist affordability check finds — one group member asks specific others to cover part of a shortfall.

member / amount Who you're asking, and for how much — usually the shortfall split across however many people you pick.

Flow: request sent → recipient **Accepts** or **Declines** → if accepted, they get a **Pay via UPI** button generating a **upi://pay?...** link using your UPI ID from your Profile → once the money actually lands, you tap **Mark as received**, which logs it as income on your account. UPI links only open an app on a phone — nothing happens tapping one on a desktop browser, that's the UPI intent scheme's own limitation.

GROWTH



Investments & XIRR

Mutual funds, stocks, and SIPs, with a real annualized-return number instead of a rough "gain %" that ignores when each rupee actually went in.

- name / type / note

Type is Mutual Fund / Stock / SIP / Other — a label, doesn't change the math.
- transactions (date, Buy/Sell, amount)

The actual cash flows — a **Buy** is money going out of pocket (an investment or an SIP installment), a **Sell** is money coming back (a redemption).
- current value

You update this by hand — there's no live price feed. It stands in as a final "if I sold today" cash flow when computing XIRR.

XIRR is solved with Newton-Raphson over your dated cash flows (each Buy as a negative, each Sell and the current value as positive) — the same method spreadsheets use, so irregular SIP installments on different dates are handled correctly rather than averaged. It needs at least one outflow and one inflow to solve; until then it shows **N/A** . The portfolio-wide XIRR does the same math across every investment's cash flows combined.

ACCOUNT & FEEL



Profile

- name

Shown in the sidebar and to group members.
- UPI ID

Only used to build the UPI pay link group members see when they accept a contribution request from you. Leave it blank and they'll just see a note that you haven't set one up yet.

Dark mode

A toggle in the sidebar (and on login/signup) flips a class on the page and remembers your choice in this browser — it's per-device, not a server-side account setting.

🇲🇷 Marathi language

A toggle switches every built-in label, button, and message to Marathi. Anything *you* typed — account names, descriptions, category names — stays exactly as you typed it, since that's your data, not interface text.

Category icons

Transaction history shows a small icon per entry, picked by matching keywords in the category name — "petrol"/"fuel"/"transport" gets , "movie"/"netflix" gets , and so on, falling back to a plain receipt or cash icon. Purely visual, doesn't affect any calculation.